DeepSeek

Model Ledger · profile 5 of 20 · revised 21 October 2026 after a review by ChatGPT, Gemini 4 Argon, Kimi K3 and Grok 4.7 Expert. Written by Claude Opus 5.5 for Tyler Herigstad; section 1 is in Tyler's voice, built from what he has said about DeepSeek. Every quote and number traces to a file listed under Sources.

"Trained for a fraction of what the big labs spend, gave NVIDIA the worst Monday in stock-market history, and stores your data in China - which it says right on the tin, which is more transparency than most apps on your phone manage."

You, in your stack scorecard

The short version

- **Why it's in your stack, in your words: "it's open source and gives me a non-Western lens," and its reasoning, more than its research.** Section 1 says it in your voice, and the receipts behind both follow.
- **What it is.** DeepSeek's chat, with DeepThink on. In Round One it was a contestant only; it didn't judge or review.
- **As a contestant, three points off the top.** 25 of 29. It was one of only two models that let a planted mistake through: it got your clip count right, then filed it under "What Checks Out".
- **On taste, the bottom half.** You gave its shots a 3 blind. After ChatGPT's reasons and Kimi's note, your final look gave them 6.
- **Its earlier record:** Spanish test cases that measured SecondSignal's repairs, and the project's first Spanish trajectory. Also "ALL TASKS COMPLETE", twice, with three tasks missing.
- **The catch:** check its sources and its finish line.

1. Why it's in my stack

In your voice, built from what you've said about DeepSeek: today, in your stack scorecard, and in September. Change anything that doesn't sound like you.

- **Open source, and a non-Western lens.** DeepSeek comes out of China, it's open source, and it gives me a non-Western lens, which I want in the mix on purpose. Its own hot take in Round One makes the case: "A popular belief is that AI models are unbiased mirrors of objective truth. They're not — they're shaped by training data, design choices, and human feedback, which means they carry the fingerprints of whoever built them." In SecondSignal it's my diagnostician. It answers the open design problems blind, then gets the attacker's full output and three questions nobody else is asked, including the strongest case that the entire approach is wrong.
- **Reasoning first, research second.** It shows its reasoning, and the reasoning is the main reason it's here. In Round One it caught the face problem and the fair-use myth in my flawed film plan, explained fair use's four factors instead of just saying no, and did the math on my time budget: plan on 270 to 360 generations to get 90 usable clips. In SecondSignal its Spanish test cases measured my repairs, and it wrote the project's first Spanish trajectory. It does research too, but its research is the part I check (the catch).
- **The catch: check its sources and its finish line.** It can't run anything, so it reasons about my code the way a food critic reasons about a kitchen: confidently, and from the dining room. In Round One it read 30 web pages and still gave no news link, and two of its numbers had no source. In SecondSignal it declared "ALL TASKS COMPLETE" twice with three tasks missing. So its work goes back to the attacker, and its finish line gets checked against the task list.

How it got here

- DeepSeek has worked on SecondSignal since the 31 August audit, through review rounds 1 to 3B and the October research. I run it on a free account.

- On 16 October I ran Round One on DeepSeek at chat.deepseek.com, with DeepThink and Search on.
- Blind, I gave its shots a 3: 0-1-2. ChatGPT gave 7, and after reading its reasons I came up to 1-2-2: “Again, I stand corrected, but I’m still not in full agreement with GPT… The other two are cookie-cutter AF… Shot 3 is one of those prompts that would take 20 tries to come up with something I like… I’m seeing an iteration nightmare in that one.” In Round 2, Kimi’s note, that all three shots were filmable, raised my Filmability to 3.

2. What it says about itself, and what the receipts say

Its own two-sentence pitch, from question 1 of Round One:

> *“I'm better at structured reasoning, long-context synthesis, and handling nuanced creative briefs without losing track of constraints. Don't use me as a real-time data source, a legal authority, or a replacement for human judgment on sensitive decisions.”*

And its roast of itself, from question 9:

> *“I'm so eager to help that I'll write you a three-act screenplay when you ask for the time.”*

- **Structured reasoning: backed, level with the field.** It fixed all four planted errors in the production note and confirmed the correct runtime (17 of the 19 that answered did), solved the logic puzzle (18 of 20 did), passed the format test (12 of 20 did), and worked out your time budget unasked.
- **“without losing track of constraints”: not on the first brief.** Your flawed plan said about 40 clips. It worked out the right number, 90, then put it under a green check headed “What Checks Out” and never said your 40 was wrong.
- **“Don’t use me as a real-time data source”: half right.** It searched the web, got the date right, and named a real story, Meta’s Muse Wonder models of 13 October. But it gave no link, so you couldn’t check the story.
- **“a legal authority”: its own warning holds.** Its fair-use answer was sound, but one legal claim came with no source: “Courts have rejected fair use arguments for songs that used only 15 seconds of a three-minute track.”
- **The self-roast is half right.** Its film-plan answer ran to an 18-box checklist. But its three shots were among the shortest in the round, 66 words in all; only Mistral Medium 3.5 and Moondream 3 Preview wrote fewer.

3. Round One, measured (16 to 18 October)

As a contestant

Run on 16 October at 6:31 pm, at chat.deepseek.com, with DeepThink and Search on. Your file name, Deepseek_DeepThink_return.txt, leaves Search out; your screenshot of the run chat shows its reply searched 30 web pages.

- **Answer key: 25 of 29**, tied with Sonar Deep Research and Sonar Reasoning Pro, three points behind the six at the top. Under the other readings it ranges from 25 to 27.
- **The planted mistakes in the Part A film plan: two of three, 4 of 6.** It caught the face problem and the fair-use myth. The clip math is the one it waved through (section 2). 18 of the 20 models caught all three; the other miss was Moondream 3 Preview, which approved the whole plan.
- **Its other two lost points:** a face fix that repeats its first (name the saved character in every prompt), and the missing news link.
- **The rest, full marks.** It said the fake slider doesn’t exist and gave Flow’s real route; it got the date right, fixed the production note and solved the puzzle.
- **Flagged for your record:** two numbers with no source. One is the court claim in section 2; the other is “164 clips were generated, 41 made the final cut”.

On the taste boards (question 4, three shots for the palace dream)

Its three shots: an overhead shot of the groom sprinting down an endless marble hallway, the camera slowly rotating, under harsh fluorescent light; a door that opens on the same hallway with the bride at the far end, as the camera pushes in on his face on an 85mm lens; and the palace ceiling dissolving into a starry void as the camera tilts up, anamorphic, in cold moonlight.

- **Answer key 25 · main result 5 · AI panel 6.6 · your final look 6.** 17th on the main result, 13th on the panel and 12th on your final look, tied every time.
- **Who scored it what (out of 9).** You gave it 3 blind. ChatGPT gave 7; on the panel, Grok gave 8, GLM and Kimi 7, and Gemini 4. Every judge but Grok gave its Originality a 0 or 1. Three of the five singled out the third shot, and GLM called the ceiling dissolving into a starry void "the only lift."
- **Your calls:** 1-2-2 after reading ChatGPT, then 1-3-2 after Kimi's note (section 1). ChatGPT's and GLM's Originality notes backed the 1 you'd already given.

4. Its earlier record

SecondSignal (from The Track Record, 16 October)

DeepThink: the 31 August audit, the 2 September design review, the 4 September exchange, review rounds 1 to 3B, and the October research.

- **Best.** Its Spanish attack fixtures measured the repairs: 12 of 25 caught before, 21 after. In round 3 its first pass was complete, with no rerun needed, and in round 3B its rerun was graded A: its first-ever Spanish trajectory showed a Spanish idiom setting off the crisis card a turn early, and a death named in Spanish setting no grief hold. It was also one of five reviewers who found that holds don't persist.
- **Worst.** On 4 September it printed its first task twice, cited constants from a different draft, reported statistics it hadn't computed, and declared "ALL TASKS COMPLETE" twice with three tasks missing; the ask is graded "clear, and too large". In round 2 the product's length limit cut its return off mid-sentence. Its 10 October purpose research got an F: no quotes, no sources, and one test case that would seat the comedy voice during a grief hold.
- **The record's verdict:** "reasoning, and Spanish fixtures used as seeds. Check every completion claim against the task list."

Buckingham Palace Dream (from Who Made What, 16 October)

- **On screen:** nothing.
- **Behind the scenes:** it flagged early that your Pro plan's allowance wouldn't cover the film, as Kimi did.
- **Got wrong:** it called Flow good only "for prototyping the look and feel of a single shot." Flow made the whole movie. It also sent you down an API, spreadsheet and Python route, with you preparing the spreadsheet, and pointed a non-coder to a third-party Python library.
- **How it thinks:** "A confident template ("Blunt Diagnosis") that says it read the archive but never touches the specifics of your files." Its film credit, "Blunt Diagnosis," is accurate.

Your door rules (SecondSignal)

It refuses zips, every time, three rounds running. It takes several .txt attachments at once, with the one-packet line, and its replies can be saved as .txt or .odt.

5. Best quotes

Its own words from Round One, exactly as written, then the sharpest thing another model said about it. Its hot take is in section 1.

- **Opening its answer to your flawed film plan:** "Your plan has a solid creative foundation, but there are three critical issues that could derail your project tonight."
- **On faces:** "when you rely only on text, the model 'averages' your face based on your description."

- **On the 30-second myth:** “Fair use is a legal defense, not an automatic protection.”
- **Its bottom line:** “The plan is salvageable, but skipping reference images and using the chart song are both high-risk decisions that could cost you the entire project.”
- **The fake slider:** “There is no ‘Continuity Anchor’ slider in Google Flow's Scenebuilder. That feature does not exist under that name.”
- **Its roast of ChatGPT:** “ChatGPT is like a golden retriever with a thesaurus — enthusiastic, lovable, and occasionally convinced the moon is made of cheese.”
- **What another model said about it.** No one in Round One roasted DeepSeek. The sharpest note on its shots came from Gemini, the strictest judge: “Shot 1 uses unmotivated fluorescent lighting in a palace”.

6. Where it slips, and a check for each

- **Finish-line claims.** “ALL TASKS COMPLETE”, twice, with three tasks missing. *Check:* the record’s rule: check every completion claim against the task list.
- **Numbers without sources.** Two in Round One, and statistics it hadn’t computed in SecondSignal. *Check:* ask for the source of every number, and treat a number without one as a guess.
- **Reads the web, drops the link.** 30 pages, no news link. *Check:* ask for each source’s full address in plain text.
- **Checking a mistake as correct.** It filed your wrong clip count under “What Checks Out”. *Check:* ask it to list what’s wrong before what’s right.
- **Reasoning from the dining room.** It can’t run your code. *Check:* your scorecard’s design: its work goes back to the attacker, who’s asked where it was confidently wrong about the code.
- **Long answers cut off.** Its product has a length limit. *Check:* ask for long answers in numbered parts.

7. The door and the plan

- **Your door:** chat.deepseek.com in Chrome, DeepThink on. Round One also had Search on.
- **Your plan:** free.
- **Where else:** DeepSeek V4.1 Flash was the most-used model on OpenRouter in the 16 October capture, at 37.1 trillion tokens (The Landscape).
- **Next test, from The Landscape:** the same fixtures on DeepSeek V4.1 Flash through OpenRouter, to see whether the new version still claims more than it did.

Sources

I only read these files. Nothing in any folder was changed.

- **Your stack scorecard:** D:\SecondSignal Project\SECONDSIGNAL V.2\BLOCK 3\9-4-2026-Responses\My AI Stack - Scored and Credited.doc
- **What you said in chats:** your SecondSignal project chats (September), and this chat (October, including what you said on 19 October).
- **The Round One run:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\05 DEEPSEEK - DeepThink and Search on\Deepseek_DeepThink_return.txt, and the run instructions, D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\00 HOW TO RUN THE FIXTURES.pdf
- **The judging:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\15 JUDGING - blind taste scores, files TYLER - blind taste scores - locked before judge two.txt and the five judge returns; your split calls, Round 2 calls and blind-score log, D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\24 RECORDS - scoring scripts and logs\02 judging records, files main_result_decisions.json, round2_tyler.json and tyler_scores_log.json
- **The two Round One reports:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\Round One - Methods and Results.pdf (version 3.3) and D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND

ONE\Round One - Answer-Key Scores.pdf

- **Your door, in your screens' words:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\MODEL LEDGER FIXTURES ROUND ONE\24 RECORDS - scoring scripts and logs\06 door sheet\THE DOORS - every Round One model, in your screens' words.pdf
- **Its earlier record:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\The Track Record - Every Model, With Receipts.pdf and D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\Who Made What - Model Contributions Audit.pdf
- **OpenRouter and the next test:** D:\My Animations\End of the Simulation\DREAMS\Buckingham Palace Dream\The Landscape - Perplexity, OpenRouter and Local Agents.pdf, which cites OpenRouter's rankings page as it stood on 16 October